



# MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



## SACRED TEXT

*avasīdanti me prāṇāḥ smṛtirme naśyati kṣudhā dūrbalo naṣṭasaṃjñāśca  
bhakṣyābhakṣyavivarjitaḥ d  
sodharmaṃ budhyamāno'pi hariṣyāmi śvajāghanīm e  
yadā bhaikṣaṃ na vindāmi yuṣmākamahamālaye d  
tadā buddhiḥ kṛtā pāpe hariṣyāmi śvajāghanīm e  
agnirmukhaṃ purodhāśca devānāṃ śuciṣāṇvibhuḥ d  
yathā ca sarvabhugbrahmā tathā māṃ viddhi dharmataḥ e*

— ~~6911051~~ (Chapter 12), Verses 52-54

## GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The verses from the Mahabharata paint a stark picture of desperation and a moral dilemma. A starving Vishwamitra, a sage known for his immense spiritual power, finds himself in dire straits. He laments that his life force is waning, his memory fading, and hunger overwhelming him. Weakened and losing consciousness, he is no longer able to distinguish between what is permissible to eat and what is forbidden. He declares that even knowing it is against dharma, he is prepared to steal the hindquarters of a dog (śvajāghanīm) to survive. He justifies this unthinkable act by stating that when he finds no alms at your homes, he is driven to this sinful thought. Finally, he asserts that he is like Agni, the fire god, who is the mouth of the gods, the purifier, and the all-consuming Brahma. Therefore, he should be considered righteous even in this act.

This passage isn't merely about physical hunger; it's a powerful allegory for the challenges we face when our basic needs are threatened. Vishwamitra's internal conflict mirrors your own struggles when you are pushed to your limits. How far will you go to survive, to protect your family, to achieve your goals? The scripture forces you to confront the ethical compromises you might be willing to make when under extreme pressure.

In modern life, this translates to the pressures of work, finances, and relationships. Are you willing to compromise your values to get ahead at your job? Would you sacrifice your integrity for financial gain? Vishwamitra's justification, likening himself to Agni, serves as a reminder that we often rationalize our actions, even when we know they are wrong. We tell ourselves that the ends justify the means, or that our circumstances excuse our behavior. However, the Mahabharata challenges you to examine these justifications critically. While survival is a fundamental instinct, the path you choose to survive defines your character and your dharma. The question is, can you find a way to navigate hardship without sacrificing your moral compass entirely?

## REFLECTION FOR TODAY

*Are there areas in your life where you are rationalizing actions that contradict your values, and how can you realign your choices with your inner sense of right and wrong?*